

Robin Rowland

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PhD Candidate

Sippy Downs QLD

[LinkedIn](#)

Key Skills

Data management | Statistical analysis (R)
Project coordination | Stakeholder
engagement | Scientific communication

Wildlife ecologist with demonstrated experience in data management, technical analysis and reporting, and stakeholder engagement across academic, government, and community partners. Skilled in maintaining large ecological datasets and communicating complex scientific information to diverse audiences. Proven project coordination and committee experience, strong statistical analysis skills in R.

Education

2023-Present (anticipated completion Dec 2026) **Doctor of Philosophy**

University of the Sunshine Coast, Thesis: Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats

2012-2016 **Bachelor of Arts (Honours Program), Animal Behaviour**

Eckerd College, USA

Relevant Experience

Feb 2023- Present

PhD Researcher, University of the Sunshine Coast, QLD

- Lead a research project examining the effects of urbanisation and roost environments on insectivorous bat health and physiology
- Developed open-access continental-scale database of Australian bat roost associations and a complementary functional-trait database
- Work with private landholders, non-profit organisations and state and local government and communicate findings to stakeholders
- Mentor and assist with supervision and experimental design of six student research projects (three undergraduate, three honours)

Oct 2024- Present

Bat Walk Workshop Leader, Moreton Bay Council, QLD

- Organise and lead annual citizen science bat walks and public workshops

Mar 2024- Present

Student Scholar, GBatNet Global Union of Bat Diversity Networks

- Participate in international working groups and meetings involving bat researchers, conservation practitioners and other specialists
- Collaborate on a global review of Data Deficient bat species, including the creation, cleaning, managing of large citation database
- Contribute to development of globally relevant scientific communication guidelines as part of a Global Bat Communication Guidelines Working group

Mar 2023 – Present

Tutor, University of the Sunshine Coast, QLD

ANM100 — Animal Ecology Field Course (×3)

- Deliver course component on bat acoustics and provide support and instruction for first-year university students on field course to North Stradbroke Island (Minjerribah)
- Demonstrate ecological field techniques (transects, acoustic monitoring, animal identification) across diverse terrains, adapting delivery to varied student abilities

ANM103 — Animal Form and Function (×3)

ENS222 — Terrestrial Vertebrate Diversity & Ecology (×2)

- Instruct university students on laboratory techniques and scientific writing, moderate student discussions, and mark assignments with quick turnarounds
- Lead student groups on annual vertebrate identification field trips

Aug 2017-Feb 2023

Outreach Coordinator, Tamborine Mountain Glow Worm Caves, QLD

- Liaised with tour and school groups, production companies and news agencies to deliver tailored wildlife conservation information in fast-paced environment
- Represented company at academic conferences and in communication with public and scientific community through emails, reports and reviews

Aug 2019 – Nov 2019

Volunteer, Southern Cross University Glider Program, Brisbane QLD

- Captured, collected, and recorded data from wild squirrel and sugar glider individuals
- Installed and removed Elliot traps at study sites around the Brisbane area

Jun 2016-Nov 2016

Research Intern, Busch Gardens Animal Research Center, USA

- Collected and analysed behavioural, physiological and parasite data on range of mammalian and avian species
- Coordinated with other researchers to design novel experiments and deliver results from multiple parallel projects to internal and external stakeholders

May 2015-Aug 2015

Research Intern, Savannah State University Dolphin Science Lab, USA

- Collected behavioural and environmental data on bottlenose dolphin individuals in the field during weekly surveys and assisted in database updates and maintenance
- After internship concluded, worked remotely with lab to complete study examining injury rates in local dolphin populations

Service Roles

2026

Bats in Buildings Working Group Member

Contributed to fact sheets for Australian land managers and public

2026

UniSC HDR Retreat Organising Committee

Event planning and logistics, including scheduling, correspondence and bookings

2025-Present	<i>Treasurer, UniSC Ecological Society</i> Facilitate meetings, budget acquittals and event coordination
2020-2024	<i>Committee Member, Wildlife Preservation Society of QLD - Scenic Rim</i> Workshop and volunteer coordination
2019-Present	<i>Wildlife Rescuer & Workshop Co-Lead, Bats Queensland</i> Co-lead and facilitate annual workshops on insectivorous bat rehabilitation

Grants and Awards

2024–2026	(\$20,720 AUD, over three rounds) Holsworth Wildlife Research Endowment - <i>Insectivorous Bats in South East Queensland</i> [Lead Author]
2025	(\$21,851 AUD) GBatNet Global Union of Bat Diversity Networks - <i>Data Deficient Bat Working Group Funding</i> [Co-investigator]
2024	(\$49,586 AUD) WIRES National Research Grant - <i>Establishing vital roost characteristics to facilitate urban insectivorous bat conservation</i> [Co-investigator]
2023	(\$2,720 AUD) Holohil Transmitter Grant Program (Radio) - <i>Transmitters for Insectivorous Bats</i> [Lead Author]
2023	(\$1,197 AUD) Wildlife Acoustics Scientific Product Grant - <i>Bat Roost Identification</i> [Lead Author]
2021	(\$49,000 AUD) Landcare Led Bushfire Recovery Grants - <i>Wildlife Corridors in the Scenic Rim</i> [Lead Author]
2020	(\$9,900 AUD) Logan EnviroGrants - <i>ICUs for Bat Carers Capacity Building</i> [Lead Author]
2020	(\$1,950 AUD) Logan EnviroGrants - <i>Educational Workshops and Events for Bat Carers</i> [Lead Author]
2024	(\$49,586 AUD) WIRES National Research Grant - <i>Establishing vital roost characteristics to facilitate urban insectivorous bat conservation</i> [Co-investigator]

Invited Seminars

Apr-2026	<i>Urban Bat Ecology</i> . GBatNet 'My Field for Dummies' Online Series.
Oct-2025	<i>Bats in Our Backyards - Get to Know Our Nocturnal Neighbours</i> . University of the Third Age Sunshine Coast.
Jul-2025	<i>Introduction to Zotero and Scientific Citations</i> , UniSC Ecological Society.
Sep-2024	<i>Ecological Careers Workshop</i> , UniSC Ecological Society.

Presentations and Posters

- Aug-2026 *Physiological tools for monitoring urban impacts at the roost level in insectivorous bats.* Joint Conference of the Australian Mammal Society and Australasian Bat Society, Australia.
- Nov-2025 *Bats Are in The Building: Understanding Anthropogenic Roost Selection Through Habitat Models.* Ecological Society of Australia Conference. Australia.
- Dec-2025 *Stressed out bats: developing tools to monitor physiological stress in three insectivorous species.* Australian and New Zealand Society for Comparative Physiology and Biochemistry Meeting, Australia.
- Aug-2025 *No one size fits all: Exploring Anthropogenic roost selection across an Urban Gradient in South East Queensland.* 20th International Bat Research Conference, Australia.
- Aug-2025 *The system works: post-release survival of rehabilitated insectivorous bats in Australia.* 20th International Bat Research Conference, Australia.
- Jul-2025 *Home is where the bats are: Bats in man-made structures in South East Queensland.* Animal Ecology Seminar Series, The University of the Sunshine Coast, Australia.
- Apr-2024 *From rugs to rocky overhangs: diverse microclimates of natural and anthropogenic bat roosts in South East Queensland.* 21st Australasian Bat Society Conference, Australia.
- Apr-2024 *Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, a Public Dataset (Poster).* Australasian Bat Society Conference. Australia. ***Runner Up Student Poster.**
- Oct-2024 *Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, a Public Dataset (Poster).* North American Bat Society Conference, Mexico.
- Nov-2023 *Working with Bat Landlords to Study the Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats in South East Queensland.* Australian Citizen Science Conference, Australia.
- Feb-2020 *The Success of a Wildlife Corridor on Tamborine Mountain and the Value of Landcare.* Wildlife Preservation Society Scenic Rim Corridors Workshop, Australia
- Dec-2019 *The Scenic Rim and Its Potential Role as an Ethical Wildlife Tourism Destination.* The Scenic Rim as an Environmentally-Sustainable International Wildlife Destination Workshop, Australia.
- Oct-2018 *Can Glow-worm Ecotourism Lead to Increased Conservation Knowledge and Positive Intentions Towards Glow-worms in the Wild?* 5th National Wildlife Tourism Australia Conference, Australia.
- Apr-2015 *Can Mongoose Lemurs Recognize Individual Humans? (Poster).* 23rd International Conference on Comparative Cognition, USA.
- Apr-2016 *Do Common Bottlenose Dolphins That Interact with Humans Experience Greater Rates of Anthropogenic Injuries?* Southeast and Mid-Atlantic Marine Mammal Symposium, USA. ***Best Undergraduate Oral Presentation**

Science Communication

- 28-Jan-2026 Commenting on Noosa Flying Fox Mass Entanglement Event. ABC Sunshine Coast Radio, Wide Bay, Southern Queensland
- 25-Jan-2026 Commenting on Annual Influx of Little Red Flying Foxes in the Region. ABC Sunshine Coast Radio
- 28-Aug-2024 Commenting on Arson Incident on Mooloolah Valley bat colony. [ABC Sunshine Coast](#), [ABC Australia](#)
- 25-Jul-2024 [Microbats. Chicken Nuggets, Stress and Wildlife Rescue!](#) *TalkECO Podcast*
- 23-Feb-2024 [Study to help save mini bats that fly under the radar](#). *Sunshine Coast News*
- 9-Feb-2024 Research to Save Tiny Bats from Housing Crisis. *ABC Sunshine Coast Breakfast Radio*
- 25-Jul-2023 [Little Forest Bats: Earth's Tiniest Heroes, Australian Mammal of the Year Profile](#). *Cosmos Magazine*

Outreach

- Mar-2026 Bat Workshop and Echolocation Walk, Moreton Bay Council.
- Mar-2026 Invited Speaker and Exhibit Consultant. Queensland Museum Bat Night Market Exhibit. World Science Festival Brisbane.
- Nov-2025 *Bats in Buildings on the Sunshine Coast*. Maleny Bat Night hosted by the Sunshine Coast Council.
- Oct-2025 Bats of the Sunshine Coast Workshop and Bat Walk. Mooloolah River Landcare.
- Oct-2025 *Bats in Your Backyard: Crash Course to the Bats of SEQ*. 'What's Brewing Behind the Dunes Series', Coolool CoastCare.
- Nov-2024 Bat Workshop and Spotlighting Walk. UniSC Ecological Society.
- Oct-2024 *Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats*. Maleny Bat Night hosted by the Sunshine Coast Council.
- Oct-2024 Bat Workshop and Echolocation Walk, Moreton Bay Council.
- Sep-2024 Bat Call Walk and Workshop Leader. Springfield Lakes Nature Centre.
- May-2024 *Bats and Forests: We Need Bats More Than You Think!* Maleny Wood Expo, Maleny, QLD
- Apr-2024 Bat Call Walk Leader, Microbat Discovery Walk Series. Brisbane Catchments Network.
- Oct-2023 Sunshine Coast Citizen Science Bat Walk, Sunshine Coast BioBlitz.

Skills and Certifications

Statistical analysis in R — linear modelling, mixed modelling, and spatial modelling with temporal and spatial autocorrelation (UQ R Course)

Operate and Maintain 4WD Vehicle (RIIVEH305F)

Provide Advanced Resuscitation and Oxygen Therapy First Aid (HLTAID015)

Provide Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation — CPR (HLTAID009)

Referees

Dr. Clare Stawski (Primary Supervisor) — Senior Lecturer, University of the Sunshine Coast —
cstawski@usc.edu.au — 07 5459 4761

Dr. Alexis Levengood (Co-Supervisor and Field Course Leader) — Research Fellow, University of
the Sunshine Coast — alevengo@usc.edu.au — 04 5756 6657